

LONG-TERM HOMEOWNER'S COMPLETE SELLING GUIDE

Everything You Need to Know Before You Sell

You've worked hard to build equity in your home over the years. Whether you're thinking about downsizing, relocating, or simply unlocking your investment, this guide walks you through everything you need to know - from timing and taxes to Proposition 19 and finding your next home.

1. IS NOW THE RIGHT TIME TO SELL?

Many long-term homeowners hesitate because they are unsure if the market is in their favor. Here are the key signals that suggest it may be the right time:

- ✓ Significant equity - 10+ years in SoCal typically means \$300K-\$600K+
- ✓ Your home no longer fits your lifestyle (too large, too small, or wrong location)
- ✓ Approaching retirement and want to unlock your equity
- ✓ You qualify for Proposition 19 tax benefits (age 55 or older)
- ✓ Want to trade up, downsize, or relocate closer to family

Free Tip: Get a Comparative Market Analysis (CMA) before making any decisions.
A CMA tells you exactly what your home is worth today - at no cost, no obligation.
Contact Janice: 951.367.7321 | janicechenhomes@gmail.com

2. UNDERSTANDING YOUR EQUITY

Your equity is the difference between your home's current market value and what you still owe. For long-term owners in Southern California, this number is often surprisingly large.

Purchase Price	The amount you originally paid for the home
Current Market Value	What buyers would pay today - get a free CMA to find out
Remaining Mortgage	What you still owe your lender
Your Net Equity	$\text{Market Value} - \text{Remaining Mortgage} = \text{Your Profit}$

Example: A home purchased for \$500,000 ten years ago in SoCal may be worth \$850K-\$1.2M today, meaning \$350K-\$700K in equity.

3. PROPOSITION 19 - YOUR TAX ADVANTAGE (AGE 55+)

If you are 55 or older, Proposition 19 allows you to transfer your current low property tax base to any replacement home anywhere in California - potentially saving tens of thousands every year.

Detail	What You Need to Know
Who Qualifies	Homeowners age 55+, severely disabled persons, or disaster victims
What It Does	Transfer your existing lower property tax base to your new home
Where It Applies	Any of California's 58 counties - statewide
How Many Times	Up to 3 times in your lifetime
Timing	New home must be purchased within 2 years of your sale

4. CAPITAL GAINS TAX - WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

When you sell your primary residence, the IRS provides a significant tax exclusion on your profits:

Filing Status	Tax Exclusion	Notes
Single	Up to \$250,000	On capital gains from the sale
Married Filing Jointly	Up to \$500,000	On capital gains from the sale

Requirement: Must have owned AND lived in the home as primary residence for at least 2 of the last 5 years. Always consult a licensed CPA for your specific tax situation.

5. THE SELLING PROCESS - STEP BY STEP

1	Free CMA & Strategy Session Janice evaluates your home's value, reviews comparable sales, and recommends a pricing strategy tailored to your goals.
2	Prepare Your Home Professional photography, staging guidance, and repair recommendations to maximize your sale price.
3	List & Market MLS listing, digital marketing, social media, and targeted outreach to reach qualified buyers.
4	Receive & Negotiate Offers Janice reviews every offer, explains the terms clearly, and negotiates aggressively on your behalf.
5	Escrow & Closing Coordinate inspections, appraisals, title, and all closing paperwork - fully managed from start to finish.

6. WHAT IS YOUR HOME WORTH TODAY?

Janice will provide a FREE, no-obligation Comparative Market Analysis (CMA) that includes:

- v Recent comparable sales in your neighborhood (last 90 days)
- v Active listings and your current competition
- v Price per square foot analysis
- v Estimated net proceeds after all costs and mortgage payoff
- v Recommended listing price range based on your goals

Ready to Find Out What Your Home Is Worth?

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